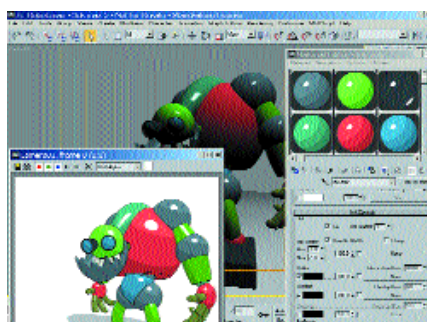


The advanced lighting support now provided with 3ds max 5 improves the realism of rendered scenes. There are two advanced lighting options. Both of them generate global illumination—illumination that comes from light that bounces off scene objects. Characteristically, global illumination can create colour



‘bleeding’, where the colour of one object can reflect onto another. Hence, now we have two new advanced lighting options: Light Tracer and Radiosity. When you apply the Light Tracer option, it gives you a natural look to the applied object. On the other hand, Radiosity, which was sold as a separate product, is based on the Lightscape engine and gives you accurate reflections of the light. The only drawback is you cannot preview the object while applying the Light Tracer function and the rendering time is much higher.

New material features include an Ink 'n Paint material for cartoon shading. This allows objects to be rendered with a cartoon look, called Toon Shading. The Toon Shader is a perfect starting point for rendering cartoon-shaded or surrealistic imagery, with specific controls for ink width and consistency, and paint style. Thus, with the inclusion of the new lighting and rendering functions, it is now possible to give your objects the realistic look which was difficult to achieve in the previous versions.

It is evident that a lot of pain has been taken by the developers to ensure tremendous increase in productivity for

3ds max 5		A-
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Ease of use	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	

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Fax: 022-6952211
E-mail: raman.madan@autodesk.com

Intel or AMD processor at 300 MHz, 256 MB RAM and 300 MB swap space, graphics card supporting 1024x768x16-bit colour, Windows-compliant pointing device (specific optimisation for Microsoft Intellimouse), DVD or CD-ROM drive

professional animators. We see no reason why you should not upgrade to this newer version. However, there is one point of concern: in 3ds max 3 you could open multiple windows in an NT-based operating system, but from version 4 this was suddenly discontinued. Besides, backward compatibility is only extended to the previous released version and not all the prevailing versions. 

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